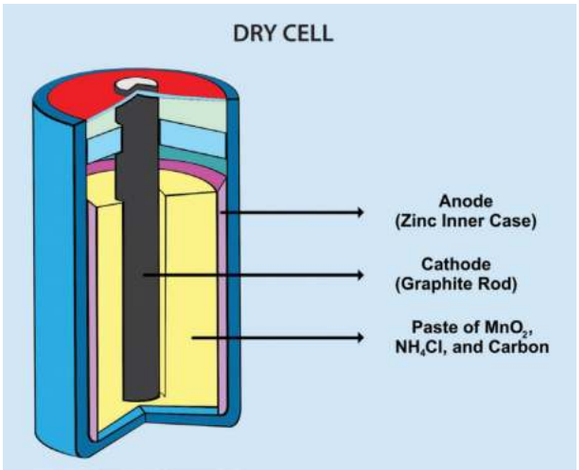


Dry cells are normaly used in small devices such as remote control for T.V, torch, camera and toys.

A dry cell is a portable form of a leclanche cell. It consists of zinc vessel which acts as a negative electrode or anode. The vessel contains a moist paste of saw dust saturated with a solution of ammonium chloride and zinc chloride.

The ammonium chloride acts as an electrolyte.

Electrolytes are substances that become ions in solution and acquire the capacity to conduct electricity.

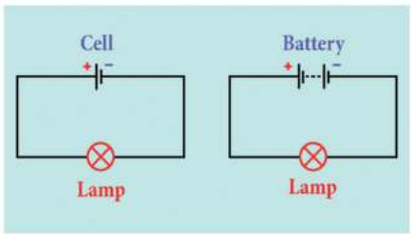
The purpose of zinc chloride is to maintain the moistness of the paste being highly hygroscopic. The carbon rod covered with a brass cap is placed in the middle of the vessel. It acts as positive electrode or cathode.

It is surrounded by a closely packed mixture of charcoal and manganese dioxide (MnO_2) in a muslin bag. Here MnO_2 acts as depolarizer. The zinc vessel is sealed at the top with pitch or shellac. A small hole is provided in it to allow the gases formed by the chemical action to escape. The chemical action inside the cell is the same as in leclanche cell.

The dry cell is not really dry in nature but the quantity of water in it is very small, as the electrolyte is in the from of a paste. In other cells, the electrolyte is usually a solution



2.3.4. Batteries



Batteries are a collection of one or more cells whose chemical reactions create a flow of electrons in a circuit. All batteries are made up of three basic components: an anode (the '+' side), a cathode (the '–' side), and some kind of electrolyte. Electrolyte is a substance that chemically reacts with the anode and cathode.

2.3.5. Invention of the Battery



One fateful day in 1780, Italian physicist, physician, biologist, and philosopher, Luigi Galvani, was dissecting a frog attached to a brass hook. As he touched the frog's leg with an iron scapel, the leg twitched.

Galvani theorized that the energy came from the leg itself, but his fellow scientist, Alessandro Volta, believed otherwise.



Volta hypothesized that the frog's leg impulses were actually caused by different metals soaked in a liquid.

He repeated the experiment using cloth soaked

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